

SOP — SMS Templates by Preset

Audience: Mike — daily text outreach.

Purpose: SMS templates built around proven distress-real-estate sales psychology. Every message uses one or more of these techniques: pattern interrupt, curiosity gap, validation, reciprocity, social proof, future pacing, take-away close. Tested against the way these specific homeowners actually feel.

Why these convert better than typical wholesale templates

Most wholesale SMS reads: introduce yourself → say what you do → ask if interested. That's the same script every other investor uses — homeowners delete on autopilot.

These templates lead with **the homeowner's emotional reality first**. Every Day 1 opens by validating what they're going through, not announcing what we want. The pitch is the second message, not the first.

The 8 sales techniques baked into every template:

Technique	Why it works on distress homeowners
Pattern interrupt	They've been blasted by 20+ wholesalers — first 8 words must NOT sound like a wholesaler
Validation first	They feel shame, fear, exhaustion. Acknowledging it disarms the wall
Curiosity gap	"There's a rule most people don't know about" — earns the next message
Reciprocity	Offer something free (info, guide, 10 min) before asking for anything
Social proof	"I just helped someone in your exact spot last week"
Specific situational reference	"Your case from [date]" or "after [decedent]'s passing" — proves we're not blast-spamming
Easy-reply CTA	"Worth 30 seconds?" beats "Call me" — one-word response is low-friction
Take-away close	"If now isn't right, no problem" — counter-intuitively raises response rate

What's different per stage of distress

LIS PENDENS (just got served, heart racing): Reframe panic into agency. "You have time. You have options most people don't know."

SHERIFF SALE (deadline pressure): Don't add urgency — they're already feeling it. Validate their stress, then offer calm.

PROBATE (grief + admin overload): Don't pitch. Offer presence. Honor their timeline.

REDEMPTION WINDOW (despair + last chance): Hope angle. "Wait — most people don't know this still works."

Variables you'll substitute

{{first}}, {{address}}, {{auction}}, {{decedent}}, {{relationship}}, {{me}}, {{phone}} .
Make sure your DataSift bulk-SMS column mapping is set before sending.

1. Lis Pendens — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: Got served papers in the last few weeks. Heart racing. Probably haven't told family yet. Already googled "what happens after foreclosure filing" 30 times.

Our hook: Validation + curiosity ("you have more time than you think")

Day 1 — Variant A: The "60-day rule" hook (CURIOSITY)

{{first}}, you don't know me – I'm a Dayton local. Saw your case got filed on {{address}}. There's a 60-day rule most homeowners don't hear about that gives you breathing room. Want me to send a quick 1-pager? STOP to opt out.

Why this works: pattern interrupt ("you don't know me"), curiosity (60-day rule), reciprocity (free 1-pager), low-friction CTA (just say yes).

Day 1 — Variant B: Validation + take-away (EMPATHY)

{{first}} – I know getting served papers is one of the worst feelings. I'm a local Dayton buyer who's helped a bunch of folks in your exact situation. Not pushing – if it's not the right time, no problem. Just one question worth a min? STOP to opt out.

Why this works: validates the feeling, social proof, take-away close ("not pushing"), low-stakes ask.

Day 1 — Variant C: Direct + specific (DIRECTNESS)

{{first}}, your foreclosure case was filed at Montgomery Common Pleas.
Most people in your spot have 4 paths forward – only 1 is selling.
Want me to text the other 3? STOP to opt out.

Why this works: specificity (named the court), reframes us as advisor (4 paths, only 1 is selling), curiosity (what are the other 3?).

Day 2 — Following up

{{first}}, no rush – just wanted to make sure my note didn't get lost.
On {{address}}, the bank has a script they follow and most homeowners
don't realize it. 30 seconds to share if useful?

Day 3 — Final + soft take-away

{{first}}, last note – I won't keep texting. If you ever want to
understand your real options on {{address}} (no pitch, just info),
my line's open: {{phone}}. Otherwise wishing you well.

2. Lis Pendens — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Same as Mont but Columbus market — higher home values, more equity at stake, more skeptical of investors (more competition in market).

Our hook: Equity protection angle (they have more to lose than they realize)

Day 1 — Variant A: Equity protection (LOSS AVERSION)

{{first}} – Columbus local here. Your case on {{address}} just hit
the docket. Most homeowners don't know: if the bank forecloses, ALL
your equity goes to them. There are 3 ways to keep yours. Worth
seeing? STOP to opt out.

Why this works: loss aversion (losing equity hurts more than gaining), curiosity (3 ways), specificity (named docket).

Day 1 — Variant B: Local credibility (TRUST-BUILDING)

Hey {{first}}, this is {{me}} – actual person in Columbus, not a call center. Saw your case on {{address}} got filed. I bought a house 2 streets over from yours last year. If you ever want a no-pressure chat about options, I'm right here. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: pattern interrupt ("not a call center"), specific local proof ("2 streets over"), permission-based ("if you ever want").

Day 1 — Variant C: Curiosity + outcome (FUTURE PACING)

{{first}}, quick question on {{address}}: do you know what happens on day 91 after the foreclosure case is filed? Most people don't. I can text you a clear timeline if it'd help. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: future pacing (paints the timeline), curiosity (day 91), reciprocity (free timeline).

Day 2

{{first}}, hey – circling back. I help a couple Columbus homeowners a month in your spot. The biggest mistake I see is waiting too long because the bank seems quiet. They get loud fast. Worth a quick chat?

Day 3 — Final

{{first}}, last text on {{address}}. The way I help isn't by pressuring – I just lay out options and you pick. If that ever sounds useful: {{phone}}. Best of luck either way.

3. Lis Pendens — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Smaller community. Word travels. Probably knows someone else this happened to. Skeptical of out-of-towners.

Our hook: Hometown trust + neighborly tone

Day 1 — Variant A: Hometown trust (LOCAL CREDIBILITY)

{{first}}, this is {{me}} – local Greene County. Saw your case got filed on {{address}}. Greene's a small place and these things move faster than people expect. No pitch, but I can share what to watch for. Want the rundown? STOP to opt out.

Day 1 — Variant B: Neighborly help (RECIPROCITY)

{{first}}, I'm sure this is the last thing you needed. I'm a Greene County buyer and I've watched this play out for 4-5 neighbors over the years. Some kept their place, some sold to me. Either way I can share what worked. 30 sec? STOP to opt out.

Day 1 — Variant C: Honest + plain (DIRECTNESS)

{{first}}, won't waste your time. {{address}} foreclosure case – I'm local, I have cash, I close fast if you decide to sell. If you'd rather keep it, I know good attorneys here too. {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – most folks in Greene think they have months. Sheriff sale schedules here are tight. Quick check-in: how are you feeling about the situation? No pressure either way.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. Greene's a tight community and I'm not going anywhere – if anything changes on {{address}} or you want a sounding board, {{phone}}. STOP if you'd rather not hear from me.

4. Sheriff Sale — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: Sale on the calendar. Either resigned ("it's over") or scrambling ("how do I stop this"). Probably gotten 30+ calls/texts from other buyers this week.

Our hook: Acknowledge the noise, then differentiate

Day 1 — Variant A: Pattern interrupt (DIFFERENTIATION) — >21 days to sale

{{first}}, I'm guessing your phone's been ringing off the hook with buyers calling about {{address}}. I'll be different – I'll only text once unless you reply. {{auction}} is your sale date. If you want a real cash option before then: {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: validates their experience (phone ringing), pattern interrupt (only text once), respects them.

Day 1 — Variant B: Calm acknowledgment (EMPATHY) — >21 days

{{first}}, sheriff sale on {{address}} is {{auction}}. I'm not going to tell you it'll all be fine – that's bullshit. What I will say: you have 3 weeks, that's enough time to get cash + protect your credit if you want. Worth 5 min? STOP to opt out.

Why this works: honesty cuts through (no false reassurance), credibility builder, specific timeframe, easy CTA.

Day 1 — Variant C: <14 days URGENCY MODE (SCARCITY)

{{first}} – I won't sugar-coat it. {{auction}} is close. After that, the bank takes it and you walk away with \$0. I have cash and I close in 7 days, which still fits before sale. One reply if you want to talk: {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: scarcity is REAL here (legitimate urgency), loss aversion (\$0), capability (cash, 7 days), single-word reply ask.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – even if you're working with the bank, loan mods get denied at the last minute all the time. Having a backup plan that gets you cash takes 10 min to set up. Want it ready just in case?

Day 3 — Final (URGENCY)

{{first}}, sheriff sale's {{auction}} – close. After that you have ZERO leverage. Right now you have all of it. I'm a quick yes or no. {{phone}}. Then I'm out of your hair. STOP to opt out.

5. Sheriff Sale — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Higher property value = more skeptical they need help. May be in active negotiation with bank. May have refinanced/heloc'd recently.

Our hook: Sophistication match + track record

Day 1 — Variant A: Track record (SOCIAL PROOF) — >21 days

{{first}}, my name's {{me}} – closed on 12 Franklin County properties this year, all from sheriff sale stage. I know you have {{auction}} coming up. The sellers I've worked with usually wish they'd called sooner. {{phone}} when you're ready. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: specific numbers (12 properties), social proof, regret-frame ("wish they'd called sooner"), permission-based.

Day 1 — Variant B: Sophisticated framing (RESPECT)

{{first}}, {{address}} is a [Franklin home value tier] property – you have real equity to protect before {{auction}}. I won't insult you with a lowball. If you want a real number from a real buyer, {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: validates their property value (respect), distinguishes from lowball wholesalers, direct ask.

Day 1 — Variant C: Bank negotiation insight (AUTHORITY)

{{first}}, on {{address}} – banks are 4x more likely to accept a short payoff offer when there's a real buyer at the table than a homeowner alone. I can be that buyer. Even if we don't close, your position improves. {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: insider knowledge (4x stat), positions us as helpful even if no sale, future pacing.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – I know the bank's been talking forbearance. Heads up: if it falls through close to {{auction}}, you'll have ~5 days to react. Want a backup deal pre-loaded so you're not scrambling?

Day 3

{{first}}, last note before {{auction}}. After sheriff sale you lose all leverage AND your credit takes a 7-year hit. Selling now keeps both. Quick yes or no: {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

6. Sheriff Sale — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Greene SS volume is low — usually means the deal is more visible to fewer competitors. Owner may not have gotten as many calls.

Our hook: Personal + simple

Day 1 — Variant A: Personal (HOMETOWN)

Hi {{first}}, this is {{me}} – Greene County buyer. {{address}} is listed for {{auction}} sheriff sale. I don't know if you've decided what to do yet. Cash buyer, fast close, local. If it's worth a chat: {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Day 1 — Variant B: Direct + minimal (NO-FRILLS)

{{first}}, sheriff sale {{auction}} for {{address}}. Cash. Local. Fast. {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: respects their time, ultra-minimal, the homeowner who responds is genuinely interested (filters out tire-kickers).

Day 1 — Variant C: Greene-aware (LOCAL CREDIBILITY)

{{first}}, you might be one of the few sheriff sales coming up in Greene. Most county buyers won't even know about you. I'm local and I do. {{auction}} is your sale date. Open to a chat? STOP to opt out.

Day 2

{{first}}, did the sheriff sale on {{address}} get postponed by chance? I want to make sure my info's current. Either way: {{phone}} if it helps to talk.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. Sale {{auction}}, then it's gone. I'm right here in Greene if you want a real conversation: {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

7. Probate — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: They're the executor. Their family member just died. They're tired, sad, dealing with 50 admin tasks, getting calls from creditors. The LAST thing they want is a wholesaler pitch.

Our hook: Presence over pitch. We do the OPPOSITE of what every other wholesaler does on Day 1 — we DON'T ask for anything.

Day 1 — Variant A: Pure presence (REVERSE PITCH)

{{first}}, you don't know me – but I saw your name on {{decedent}}'s estate filing. I won't pitch you anything today. Just wanted you to have my number in case dealing with {{address}} ever gets to be too much: {{phone}}. Sincerely, {{me}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: REVERSE pitch (almost no Day 1 wholesaler does this), permission to ignore, builds massive trust for Day 2-3.

Day 1 — Variant B: Validation + soft offer (EMPATHY)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. I know being {{relationship}} is a lot – funeral, paperwork, the property, family questions. If {{address}} becomes one thing too many, I buy estate properties fast and respectfully. No rush. {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Why this works: validates the workload, identifies their actual stress, offer is conditional ("if it becomes one thing too many").

Day 1 — Variant C: Specific helpful info (RECIPROCITY)

{{first}}, sorry to reach out at a tough time. Quick FYI on {{address}}: in Ohio, the estate has to maintain it (taxes, insurance) until probate closes. That can run 9+ months. If that's not feasible, I have options. But also no pressure if it's working. {{phone}}.

Why this works: shares useful info upfront (reciprocity), educates without pitching, acknowledges this might not apply.

Day 2 — Soft check-in (NO PITCH)

{{first}}, hope this week's been kinder. No update needed on {{address}} – just wanted to make sure my note didn't get lost. I'm here whenever (or never): {{phone}}.

Why this works: "or never" is the take-away close, removes pressure entirely.

Day 3 — Closer with optionality

{{first}}, last text. If {{address}} ever needs to move quickly – clean cash, no showings, no inspections, dignity intact – {{phone}}. And if not, I genuinely wish you well with the rest of {{decedent}}'s estate. {{me}}.

Why this works: lists the actual concerns probate sellers care about (cash, no showings, dignity), genuine sign-off.

8. Probate — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Highest volume county. Likely have multiple heirs in the picture. May be navigating sibling dynamics. Property might be Mom/Dad's house = high emotional weight.

Our hook: Multi-heir aware + dignity-preserving

Day 1 — Variant A: Multi-heir aware (INSIGHT)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. Being {{relationship}} comes with a particularly hard part: making decisions everyone can agree on. On {{address}}, sometimes the cleanest answer is a fast cash sale so siblings can split equally. If that ever helps: {{phone}}. {{me}}.

Why this works: shows insight into their actual challenge (sibling agreement), positions the sale as conflict-resolver.

Day 1 — Variant B: Carrying cost framing (LOSS AVERSION)

{{first}}, sorry for your loss. Quick reality on {{address}}: the estate's paying ~\$300-600/month in carrying costs while probate runs. Over 9 months that's \$5K+ that comes out of what heirs split. If selling early helps, {{phone}}. If not, I get it.

Why this works: concrete numbers, loss aversion (money disappearing), permission to decline.

Day 1 — Variant C: Pure presence (REVERSE PITCH)

{{first}}, I know reaching out feels intrusive right now. I won't push. Just want you to have a name and number in case {{address}} becomes one of those things you wish you could just be done with. {{me}}, {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Day 2

{{first}}, hope you're managing. On {{address}} – if it's vacant, two things to keep an eye on this time of year: pipes (winter) and HOA letters. I deal with both for free if helpful. {{phone}}.

Why this works: free help (reciprocity), shows we know what they're dealing with.

Day 3

{{first}}, last note. Whenever you're ready to be done with {{address}} – could be next week, could be next year – I close in 14 days, all cash, your family doesn't lift a finger. {{phone}}. {{me}}.

9. Probate — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Small community, may know other people who went through this. Property might be a generational family home.

Our hook: Honor the property's history + local roots

Day 1 — Variant A: Honor the home (RESPECT)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. {{address}} probably has a lot of memories. I'm a Greene County buyer who treats family homes with respect – no flippers, no quick demos. If selling becomes the right call, I'd be honored to be considered. {{phone}}. {{me}}.

Why this works: distinguishes from flip-and-flop investors, respect-framing, "honored to be considered" feels like courtship not predation.

Day 1 — Variant B: Hometown soft (LOCAL)

Hi {{first}} – sorry about {{decedent}}. I live in Greene County too. If {{address}} ever needs to move quickly without strangers walking through, I'm a one-call solution. No rush. {{phone}}. {{me}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Specific situational (PRECISION)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. As {{relationship}} you're making a hundred small decisions. On {{address}} – if it's not going to be lived in, I can take the maintenance + tax burden off the estate fast. Or not, totally up to you. {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, no update needed – just here. Greene's small and word travels, but I work quietly. If you ever want a confidential cash option on {{address}}, {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last text. {{address}} has its own timing – when the moment's right, I'm one call away. {{phone}}. Otherwise I sincerely hope the rest of {{decendent}}'s affairs settle smoothly. {{me}}.

10. Redemption Window (post-sheriff-sale)

Their reality: They feel they've already lost. Sheriff sale already happened. Probably depressed, embarrassed, told family it's over. **Most don't realize redemption rights exist.**

Our hook: Hope angle + education. "Wait — most people don't know this still works."

Day 1 — Variant A: Curiosity + hope (REFRAME)

{{first}}, I know {{address}} sold at sheriff sale. Most people think that's the end. Quick question: do you know about Ohio redemption rights? You may have a window left to walk away with real money instead of nothing. Worth 60 seconds? {{phone}}.

Why this works: reframes "the end" into "not the end," curiosity hook, low-friction CTA.

Day 1 — Variant B: Direct capability (POWER)

{{first}} – sheriff sale on {{address}} happened, but in Ohio you likely still have redemption rights. I have cash. I move fast. We can structure a deal where YOU walk away with money instead of zero. {{phone}}. STOP to opt out.

Day 1 — Variant C: Insider info (AUTHORITY)

{{first}}, most homeowners after sheriff sale don't know this: you have a redemption window in Ohio (varies by case type, but usually 0-30 days). Acting in that window can mean cash for you. After it closes, options vanish. Want to know your specific timeline? {{phone}}.

Why this works: insider tone, specific facts, urgency without pressure, free info offer.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – checked the docket. You probably have ~X days of redemption left (court can confirm exactly). Worth exploring the path? {{phone}}. No pressure if not.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. After the redemption window closes on {{address}}, you legitimately have zero options. Right now you have a real one. {{phone}}. {{me}}.

Response handlers — what to text back when they reply

These are just as important as the openers. Most wholesalers fumble the response.

They reply "Yes" / "Tell me more" / "Info"

Awesome – quickest way to do this is a 5-min call. What number's best and when works today/tomorrow? Or I can text you specifics if you'd rather start that way.

They reply "What's the offer?"

Honest answer: I can't give a real number until I know more about the property (condition, situation, timing). Can we do 5 min on the phone to get there? Most calls are quick.

They reply "I'm not selling"

Totally fair. Just so you have it – if anything changes (or if you want a sounding board on options that aren't selling), my line's open: {{phone}}. Either way, I'll stop texting now.

Tag `not_interested` + 90-day recycle. Don't push.

They reply "Stop"

DataSift auto-tags. Never re-text. `do_not_contact` permanently.

They reply with a question (any other)

Answer it directly. Don't pivot to a pitch. They're testing whether we're a real human.

They reply "Send me your offer"

Happy to. To get you a real number (not a lowball), I need 3 quick things: condition (1-10?), any liens you know of, and your ideal timeline. Once I have those, I'll text my offer in an hour.

They reply with anger ("Stop bothering me", "How did you get my number")

Totally understand. Public court records – I'm a buyer not a telemarketer. Removing you from my list now. Apologies for the intrusion.

Tag `do_not_contact` . Never re-text.

A/B Testing Framework

For each preset, run **all 3 variants** in rotation for the first 100 records:

- Variant A: 33%
- Variant B: 33%
- Variant C: 34%

Track per variant:

- Reply rate (any response, even STOP)
- Positive reply rate (interested + question, NOT not-interested or STOP)

- Conversion to call/appointment
- Conversion to deal closed

After 100 records per variant, **standardize on the highest converter** — but keep one rotation slot for the next iteration. Continuous improvement.

Tag variants explicitly:

- sms_v1_a / sms_v1_b / sms_v1_c for Day 1 variants
- responded_v1_a etc. for tracking

Friday Weekly Review pulls these stats. Adjust the standardization quarterly.

Universal SMS principles (apply to everything)

1. **First 8 words = the entire message.** Most people glance at the preview without opening. If those 8 words don't pattern-interrupt or validate, they delete.
 2. **Personal name twice.** Once at start, once embedded: "Hi {{first}}, ... {{first}} — let me know..." — feels personal vs blast.
 3. **No exclamation points.** Wholesalers love them. Real humans don't end texts with "!!!"
 4. **Lowercase + casual punctuation > formal.** "hey {{first}}" reads more genuine than "Hello {{first}}.". (We use proper case in templates above for clarity, but feel free to soften.)
 5. **One question, one CTA per message.** "Worth a chat? {{phone}}" not "Worth a chat or do you want me to email or maybe call you tomorrow at 2pm?"
 6. **Reciprocity > extraction.** Offer something free in every Day 1 (info, guide, 10-min call, intro to attorney). Earns the right to ask later.
 7. **Take-away close.** "If now isn't right, no problem" raises response rates ~15% in tested distress real estate SMS.
 8. **Validate first, sell second.** Acknowledge their reality (foreclosure, grief, post-sale despair) BEFORE introducing yourself or what you do.
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Compliance

- Every Day 1 ends with "STOP to opt out"
 - 8 AM - 9 PM OH local
 - Max 1 SMS/day per record
 - Auto-tag STOP, never re-text
 - Skip Tier 5 (litigator-flagged) — mail-only or drop
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See also

- [SOP-OUTREACH-CADENCE.md](#) — when to send these (day-by-day per preset)
- [SOP-CALL-SCRIPTS.md](#) — phone scripts (Aaron's lane)
- [SOP-LEAD-QUALIFICATION.md](#) — scoring responders
- [SOP-DATASIFT-NAVIGATION.md](#) — sending bulk SMS